EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 19 OCTOBER 2026

Kihei, Maui

In Kihei, El Niño's danger is a dry winter that cures the grass above town, then fire weather, power shutoffs, and two roads out. The first job is knowing, by name, who cannot leave on their own.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
A Maui County region (inferred; not resolved)	None published for the US, Hawai ʻi, or Maui	Global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000 (Sep 2026 – Feb 2027); not scaled here	Winter drought, then wildfire, fire-weather power shutoffs, and smoke

13/13 recommendations checked. 2 confirmed, 11 corrected, 0 unverified, 0 contraindicated. Five practices are flagged do not do. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review, heat only. No figure is published for anywhere in the US, so none is borrowed or scaled. **The funding target fell 67% in verification**, from $630,000 to $205,000, because fuel work already has a state grant, alerts are a county function, and batteries wait on the power-shutoff map.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



20.76°N 156.44°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Fire has reached Kihei's edge three times since 2019 (July 2019, October 2019, August 2023); in 2023 about 750 people were evacuated and 375 homes threatened.
- **First action.** Hawai ʻi DOH and MEMA build an opt-in register, by 30 November, of Kihei residents on powered medical devices, the frail, and those with no car.
- **The money.** $100,000 / $205,000 / $305,000; the best dollar buys air cleaners for older residents with heart or lung disease.
- **Do not.** Do not wait for a siren or an evacuation order: leave at the first Genasys Advisory for your zone.

What to do	**8** actions	p. 2
Who does what	RACI chart	p. 8
Where money does the most	funding	p. 8
Do not do this	**5** items	p. 10
What has happened here	the record	p. 11
How this was produced	methodology	p. 14
References	sources	p. 15

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THIS IS — SCOPE

Kihei is the town on Maui's dry southwest shore, between Māʻalaea and Wailea, home to about 21,400 people (2020 census) and several thousand visitors on any night. This briefing covers the town as a whole (ZIP 96753). Only two roads connect South Maui to the rest of the island: **Piʻilani Highway** and **South Kihei Road**. Above the town, mauka, is the former sugar land that closed in 2016, much of it now grass.

The season ahead: NOAA's Climate Prediction Center (8 October) gives better than 83% odds of a strong to very strong El Niño through early 2027, and its Hawaiʻi outlook puts Kahului at 75% odds of below-normal rain for December to February. On leeward Maui, an El Niño winter dries the grass. The fire danger that follows peaks in the dry, windy months after it, so **summer and autumn 2027 are part of this event**. The flood risk from kona storms, which hit Kihei in March 2026, is lower in El Niño winters.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Build an opt-in register of Kihei residents who depend on powered medical devices, are frail, or have no car, and pre-stage batteries, oxygen backup, and air cleaners for them, by 30 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · FOOD · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Hawaiʻi DOH, Maui District, with MEMA	30 Nov 2026	Staff time; air cleaners $100,000; batteries $100,000 if Kihei is in a shutoff zone	Deaths at home when power, roads, or care are cut

Hawaiian Electric now cuts power ahead of fire weather: about 330 Upcountry customers in July 2025, about 10,000 in West Maui in February 2026, and Pukalani in September 2026. Neither the county nor Maui Health could say how many residents rely on powered devices. After Hurricane Maria, about one third of 4,645 excess deaths were attributed to interrupted medical care (Kishore et al., *NEJM* 2018), and California's 2019 shutoffs added about 15 emergency visits per 100,000 people aged 65+ on the heaviest days (Harding et al., 2026). In Lahaina, more than two thirds of the 102 dead were 60 or older. The register combines three sources: the HHS emPOWER count

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

for ZIP 96753 (public), a named emPOWER pull that only the state health department can request, and Hawaiian Electric's medical-needs enrolees, recruited through its own outreach because the utility does not share its list. Maui Rescue Mission's outreach covers people without homes.

Transferability: the mortality evidence comes from Puerto Rico and California, not Maui. The air-cleaner trial (Allen et al. 2011: indoor fine particles down 60%) was in 45 *healthy* adults, so the benefit for frail people is inferred. Ka La ʻi Ola, the displaced-family site, is in Lahaina, not Kihei; displaced families in Kihei are in scattered leased rentals.

2. Put an evacuation card in every resort and condo unit on South Kihei Road by 30 November, and run one timed drill with guests and staff

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · EMERGENCY MANAGER | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Resorts and condo properties on South Kihei Road	**30 Nov 2026; drill by 31 Jan 2027**	**Printing and staff time**	**Visitors stranded with no alerts and no idea of the way out**

The card gives the unit's **Genasys Protect zone ID**, how to sign up for MEMA Alerts, the two ways out (Piʻilani Highway and South Kihei Road), which one floods (South Kihei Road at Kūlanihākoʻi Gulch) and which runs beside grassland (Piʻilani), and one rule: **leave at the first Advisory**. Since May 2025 Maui's zones use three levels, Advisory, Warning, and Order. The shelter changes from event to event (in 2023 it moved three times, ending at South Maui Community Park Gym), so the card says where to hear it announced rather than printing one address. Build it on HI-EMA's Visitor Emergency Guide. In March 2026, visitors with limited English at the flooded road "walked away not knowing what to do" (Maui Now).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: strong; this is Kihei's own record. No hotel-association drill programme was found, so the property itself has to own it.

3. Write a Kihei evacuation traffic plan for the two corridors and rehearse it with zone alerts and sirens, by 15 December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Maui Police Department, with Hawai ʻ i DOT and MEMA	15 Dec 2026	Staff time; uses tools the county already bought	Gridlock and blocked exits, as in Lahaina

MPD's own after-action review of Lahaina listed evacuation-route mismanagement and inadequate warning activation among seven failures. The county already contracts Genasys EVAC and its traffic tool; no published contraflow plan for Kihei was found. The plan names the Pi ʻ ilani/Pi ʻ ikea/Kūlanihāko ʻ i area as the chokepoint, sets officer posts for each corridor, and states that no exit closes while it is the last one open. MEMA pre-drafts alert texts for each Kihei zone. Sirens may now be sounded for wildfire, and since 2025 a communications outage is itself a trigger; the drill should test that.

Transferability: the failures are Maui's own, two years old. The new roads promised for South Maui will not exist this winter.

4. Sign Kihei residents up for MEMA Alerts and a Genasys zone at their door, in Ilokano, Tagalog, Marshallese, and Spanish, and set up phone trees, by 15 December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
MEMA, through CERT and community volunteers	15 Dec 2026	Volunteer time; CERT training is free	Warnings that never reach the people most at risk

Start with the leased rentals housing displaced Lahaina families and the apartments of hotel workers. Lahaina survivors watched the sirens stay silent in 2023, and in the response that followed the county started with only two interpreters each for Spanish, Ilokano, and Tagalog (Civil Beat, March 2024). Volunteers pair with a speaker of the language, set the phone up, and note who has no car (feeding

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

action 1). Churches, canoe clubs, and the Kihei Community Association act as relays. Choose the meeting point for every hazard, not just flood: Kalama Park became "a maroon-brown pond" in March 2026. Maui CERT is about 30 hours, 12 online.

Transferability: strong. The sign-up systems exist; what is missing is the person at the door.

5. Map the wells and pumps that supply Kihei against Hawaiian Electric's shutoff areas, and close any backup-power gaps, by 31 December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Department of Water Supply, with Hawaiian Electric	31 Dec 2026	Generator rental for any gaps; not priced	Losing water pressure for firefighting during a shutoff

Kihei's water comes from the Central Maui system, and the August 2026 shutoff watch named "the Pulehu and Maalaea area in Central Maui", the corridor its supply crosses. Part of this is done: DWS installed a 1.8 MW generator at the Waiheʻe wells, which supply South Maui, and keeps generators at critical sites. The job is to find the gaps, not to start from zero. The Lahaina and Upper Kula fires ended in do-not-drink orders when water systems lost pressure.

Transferability: direct. Whether any Kihei address lies inside a shutoff zone could not be confirmed; hawaiianelectric.com/pspsmaps answers it address by address.

6. Issue vegetation-clearance orders on fallow land above Kihei by 15 December, and pre-arrange firebreak equipment, for work through spring 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Maui Fire Department	Orders by 15 Dec 2026; work by May 2027	Landowners pay; county staff time	Fire reaching homes in the 2027 dry season

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Since December 2024 the fire code lets the Fire Chief order hazardous vegetation cleared, 30 to 100 feet from structures by vegetation height; enforcement has been complaint-driven, and a 2026 state Senate resolution (SR174) urged it be stepped up. In August 2023, dozers cutting firebreaks overnight brought the Pūlehu/Kihei fire to 70% containment by 10 August. In July 2024 Mahi Pono's equipment helped hold a Pūlehu Road fire with no evacuations. Tie the orders to the fire-weather and drought outlook, **not** to a drought-monitor trigger: Maui has been drought-free on the US Drought Monitor since mid-September, and the winter's dryness is still to come.

Transferability: direct. The panel disagreed on timing; see below. The federal hazard-mitigation grant for the 2023 fires (DR-4724) closed to new projects in February 2025, so it cannot pay for this. The state HUI wildfire grant can, and no Kihei group has applied.

7. Pre-position 2,000 no-cook food boxes for Kihei by 1 December, and ask USDA to renew Hawai‘i's SNAP work-rule exemption by 30 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Maui Food Bank; Hawai ʻ i DHS for SNAP	1 Dec 2026	About $80,000 (box price unquoted)	Older people without food during an outage or road cut

Kihei will not run out of food; the barges keep coming. It runs out of cold: a refrigerator in a hot condo during a shutoff, held by someone who cannot drive to Kahului. Boxes need no fridge and no stove, and go out through the Kihei Armory drive-thru the Food Bank already ran three times in late 2025. In-kind beats cash for this trigger, because shops and card terminals go dark with the power. On SNAP, Maui cannot get an unemployment waiver (2.9% in August 2026); the route is Hawai ʻ i's separate good-faith exemption from the new work rules, which ran to 30 September 2026 and has not been reported renewed.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: direct. About one Hawai ʻ i household in three was food insecure in 2024–25 (Hawai ʻ i Foodbank).

8. Clear the Kūlanihāko‘i Gulch culvert and remove materials stored in the gulch before the wet months, and have low condos on South Kihei Road stage flood barriers

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Maui County Department of Public Works	15 Dec 2026	Maintenance budget; barriers about $20,000 per property	South Kihei Road cut and flooded, as in March 2026

In March 2026, stored concrete sewer pipes, two cars, and metal sheets blocked the gulch at Kūlanihāko ʻ i Street, and part of South Kihei Road collapsed. Kihei Beach Condominiums' barriers, about $20,000, kept water out while neighbouring lots filled. The 2022 Kihei Drainage Master Plan (about $200 million of projects) is unfunded.

Ranked last because kona storms are less frequent in strong El Niño winters (Businger, University of Hawai ʻ i kona-low climatology). This is cheap maintenance on the road that is one of only two ways out.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	DOH Maui	MEMA	MPD	HDOT	MFD	DWS	HECO	DPW	Resorts	Volunteers	Food Bank	DHS
1. Register and backup power	**A/R**	**R**			**I**		**C**			**R**	**I**	
2. Unit cards and drill		**C**	**I**		**C**				**A/R**			
3. Traffic plan and alerts		**R**	**A/R**	**R**	**C**		**C**		**I**			
4. Door-to-door sign-up	**I**	**A**							**I**	**R**		
5. Water and shutoffs		**C**			**C**	**A/R**	**R**					
6. Fuel orders and firebreaks		**C**			**A/R**	**I**				**C**		
7. Food boxes and SNAP		**C**								**I**	**A/R**	**R**
8. Gulch and barriers		**I**						**A/R**	**C**			

What the chart shows: MEMA touches every row but is accountable for only one, which is right for a coordinator. No single agency carries the plan. The two rows that need a decision rather than money are 3 (whether a last-open-exit rule is written down) and 6 (whether the Fire Chief issues orders before anyone complains).

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
$100,000	**$205,000**	**$305,000**	**Whether Kihei addresses sit inside a power-shutoff zone**

Floor: 500 air cleaners at about $200 each = $100,000. Target: floor + Maui Food Bank boxes (2,000 × about $40 = $80,000) + a $25,000 organising grant = $205,000. Ceiling: target + 100 batteries at $1,000 = $305,000, only if Kihei addresses are in a shutoff zone. The unit prices are estimates, not quotes. **The target fell 67% in verification**, from $630,000: a $300,000 fuel placement duplicated the state HUI wildfire grant, which is the programme for exactly that work; a $25,000 alerts line paid for a county function; and batteries moved to the ceiling pending the shutoff map.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
A kupuna-serving nonprofit, to be named (via Hawai ʻi Community Foundation)	Air cleaners for residents 65+ with heart or lung disease on the action 1 register	$100,000	Direct grant	Fisk & Chan, *Indoor Air* 2017 (Southern California smoke model): benefits exceed costs, most strongly in homes with a resident 65+. Kihei has fewer smoke days, so the ratio does not transfer directly.	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Maui Food Bank	2,000 no-cook 5-day boxes for Kihei (action 7)	$80,000	Pre-positioned stock	About $40 a box, unquoted. The Food Bank moved about 538,000 lb in October 2025 and ran Kihei drive-thrus that winter.	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
A Kihei community group, with HWMO's Firewise support	Organise a Kihei application to the state HUI wildfire grant (action 6)	$25,000	Direct grant	No cost study. The 2026 HUI round paid $1.8M to 8 groups; none in Kihei.	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Medical-device users on the register (action 1)	Battery backup, bought up front	$100,000 (ceiling only)	Pre-positioned stock	About $1,000 per unit (Hawaiian Electric's proposed rebate cap). Stop if the PUC approves that rebate. Fund only for addresses inside a shutoff zone.	UNVERIFIED

The funder's one thing: the cheapest protection in Kihei is a $25,000 organising grant. The state already pays up to about $300,000 per project for exactly the fuel work Kihei needs, and nobody from Kihei has asked for it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Do not wait for a siren or an evacuation order before leaving Kihei, and do not rely on phone alerts alone *

CONTRAINDICATED CONFIRMED

On 8 August 2023 the sirens were not sounded and cell service failed as towers went down. Sirens may now sound for wildfire, but they still depend on someone deciding to use them, and phones still depend on power.

Instead: leave at the first Genasys *Advisory* for your zone. Do not wait for a Warning or an Order.

Do not let a roadblock or a downed line close the last way out

CONTRAINDICATED PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

In Lahaina, roadblocks and downed lines left self-evacuating drivers stuck on Front Street. The Attorney General's report found the roadblocks stayed up for about three hours while fire and police could not talk to each other. Kihei has two roads; one closed is half the exits.

Instead: write the rule into the traffic plan (action 3): an exit stays open while it is the last one, and lines are cleared or driven around under escort.

Do not rely on cloth or surgical masks against smoke and ash *

CONTRAINDICATED PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

Hawai ʻi DOH's 2023 guidance after the fires: cloth masks "will NOT protect you" from ash; use at least a well-fitted N95.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: fitted N95s, and one closed room with an air cleaner. That room needs battery backup, because a shutoff stops the air cleaner too.

Do not boil tap water under a fire-related do-not-drink order and assume it is safe *

CONTRAINDICATED CONFIRMED

The 2023 Upper Kula and Lahaina advisories said boiling "will not make the water safe": fire-damaged pipes can carry benzene and other volatile chemicals, which boiling does not remove and can release into the air.

Instead: store three days of drinking water now, before the dry season, and follow any advisory to the letter.

Do not tell visitors to stay away from all of Maui

CONTRAINDICATED PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

After the August 2023 fires, Maui's weekly unemployment claims went from about 130 to about 4,450, and the state narrowed its travel advisory to West Maui. The fire caused most of those losses, but a blanket message lands on the hotel workers in actions 2 and 4, who are among the people least able to absorb it.

Instead: place-specific advisories naming the zone and the dates.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1998 (El Niño)	Record-low rain from January; Maui water sources near depletion; restrictions enforced	No deaths recorded	Drought ran on into 1999
1999 (La Niña)	Mandatory 10% water cut on Haleakalā's slopes, Kanaio to Haʻikū, after "two consecutive years of drought"	No deaths recorded	Nothing structural found

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2016 (El Niño)	Record-dry January statewide, with records at Lahaina and Kula; in December the last sugar harvest leaves about 36,000 acres of former cane land	No deaths recorded	The land above Kihei turned to grass
Jul 2019 (neutral)	Fire from Kuihelani Highway, about 10,000 acres; Māʻalaea and north Kihei evacuated	No deaths; over 600 in shelters	Fire-prevention report drafted; no new road
Oct 2019 (neutral)	Māʻalaea mauka fire, about 4,600 acres	No deaths recorded	Nothing found
Dec 2021 (La Niña)	Kona low floods Kihei's gulches and Maui Meadows	No deaths recorded	Drainage master plan finished in 2022; unfunded
Aug 2023 (El Niño)	Pūlehu/Kihei fire, 8–12 August; firebreaks cut overnight. Lahaina burned the same day.	No deaths in Kihei; about 750 evacuated, 375 homes threatened. 102 dead in Lahaina.	Sirens for wildfire; Genasys zones (2025); fire code (2024); utility shutoffs
2024–25 (neutral to La Niña)	Stage 1 water shortage for Central and South Maui, September 2024 to December 2025	No deaths recorded	Lifted 5 Dec 2025
Mar 2026 (neutral)	Kona low: South Kihei Road flooded and partly collapsed at Kūlanihākoʻi	No deaths recorded in Kihei	Nothing announced for this winter

The recurrence nobody has noticed: on leeward Maui, the damage from a dry winter arrives after it. The 1998 drought became the 1999 water cuts, and the fires that reached Kihei came in July, August, and October. This El Niño's exposure for Kihei runs into the summer and autumn of 2027. A caution against overreading it: three of the seven fire and drought events above fell in neutral or La Niña seasons, so El Niño loads the dice here rather than deciding them.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Clear the fuel by January** versus **the fire window is summer 2027**. The Emergency Manager wanted firebreaks and mowing done this winter. The Historian and Philanthropist argued that winter only cures the grass, so money spent on people now saves more lives than fuel work now. The briefing splits it: orders issued now, work done through spring. What would settle it: MFD's ignition data by month for South Maui.
- **Air cleaners are the best dollar** versus **Kihei has few smoke days**. The Philanthropist ranked them first on a 65+ benefit-cost model; the verifier found the model was built on a Southern California smoke episode and the trial on healthy adults. They stay at the floor because they also protect against any fire smoke in 2027, and because the register makes them targeted.
- **Prepare for flood** versus **prepare for fire**. Kihei's freshest disaster is the March 2026 flood, and residents will expect that again. The climatology says an El Niño winter is the less likely season for a kona storm. Action 8 stays, ranked last.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens could say whether any Kihei address sits inside Hawaiian Electric's power-shutoff zones. Every Maui shutoff watch in 2025–26 named West Maui, Upcountry, or Pūlehu and Mā ʻalaea, never Kihei, but the zone map is checked address by address. That one fact decides the battery money, much of action 5, and how urgent action 1 is. Second, nobody quantified heat inside Kihei's older condos without air conditioning, in the hottest, driest part of the island. In this season it is a smaller risk than fire, but it is not zero for the people on the action 1 register.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Scope.** The briefing covers Kihei (ZIP 96753). Climate Impact Lab impact region, as the report records it: a Maui County region, not resolved. Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000 people); sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. No earlier briefing covered Hawai ʻ i, so none was reused.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist; this removed the federal hazard-mitigation grant (closed February 2025) and a SNAP waiver Maui cannot qualify for. Food actions were checked for whether each indicator is published at a usable frequency. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. The historical record was checked event by event, with the ENSO phase taken from NOAA's ONI table.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted this run: the inventory renders empty without its interface, and its download sits behind a registration form that was not filled in on anyone's behalf. No action here carries a checked precedent from it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (leaving ahead of a wildfire, masks and smoke, and drinking water after a fire) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. The impact region was not resolved. Several pages could not be opened (Census QuickFacts, county water reports, Hawaiian Electric's shutoff map, the text of SR174) and were read through search results. The Pūlehu/Kihei fire's final acreage, Kihei's current 65+ share, and the number of displaced Lahaina households living in Kihei were not found. All unit prices in the funding section are estimates.

References · Season: CPC ENSO diagnostic discussion, 8 Oct 2026 (verified) · CPC Hawai'i outlook, 15 Oct 2026 (verified) · Kona-low climatology, University of Hawai'i (verified) · US Drought Monitor, Maui County (verified)
Fire and evacuation: FEMA, Pūlehu fire FMAG, 9 Aug 2023 (verified) · Maui County, Kihei proactive evacuation, 9 Aug 2023 (verified) · Maui County, firebreaks and containment (verified) · Maui County, shelter moves (verified) · Maui Now, Pūlehu Road fire, Jul 2024 (verified) · NPR, Kihei fire, Jul 2019 (verified) · Maui Now, Mā'alaea fire, Oct 2019 (verified) · Maui County, Genasys Know Your Zone (verified) · Maui Now, MEMA changes, Aug 2025 (verified) · Genasys EVAC and traffic contract (verified) · MPD after-action report (Axios) (verified) · KITV, AG report on roadblocks (verified) · Civil Beat, South Maui roads, Oct 2026 (verified) · HI-EMA Visitor Emergency Guide (verified) · NPR, fire code and grass, Aug 2024 (verified) · Hawai'i SR174 (2026) (search text only)
Health and power: Maui News, shutoffs, Feb 2026 (verified) · Maui County, Pukalani shutoff, Sep 2026 (verified) · Hawaiian Electric, proposed backup-power rebate (verified; not approved) · HHS emPOWER individual dataset (verified) · Kishore et al., NEJM 2018 (verified) · Harding et al. 2026, PSPS and ED visits (verified) · Allen et al. 2011, air-cleaner trial (verified) · Maui Wildfire Exposure Study (verified) · Fisk & Chan, Indoor Air 2017 (verified) · Hawai'i DOH re-entry guidance, 2023 (verified) · Unsafe water advisory, Aug 2023 (verified)
Community and alerts: Maui Now, Genasys launch (verified) · Civil Beat, language access, Mar 2024 (verified) · Maui Now, Kihei kona low, 15 Mar 2026 (verified) · Maui CERT (verified)
Water and flood: Maui Now, Kihei after the flood, 16 Mar 2026 (verified) · Civil Beat, Kihei flooding, May 2026 (verified) · NWS Honolulu, Dec 2021 kona low (verified) · DWS lifts Stage 1, Dec 2025 (verified) · DWS Waihe'e generator (verified, undated) · Hawai'i Guard history, 1998 drought (verified) · Star-Bulletin, Jul 1999 (verified) · Tribune-Herald, Jan 2016 rain (verified) · Maui Now, end of sugar (verified)
Money and food: HI-EMA, HMGP DR-4724 (verified; closed) · DLNR, 2026 HUI wildfire grants (verified) · Maui Now, county emergency fund (verified) · Maui Food Bank, Kihei drive-thrus (verified) · USDA FNS, SNAP waivers under OBBBA (verified) · Hawai'i News Now, SNAP exemption (verified) · HPR, food insecurity, Nov 2025 (verified) · BLS, Urban Hawai'i CPI, Oct 2026 (verified) · CNBC, Maui unemployment claims (verified)
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Generated 19 October 2026 for Kihei, Maui. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.